man. It's just that I was a generally disliked know-it-all earlier in my life, and I am a generally liked person (I believe) who is genial and a nonpusher later in my life. Looking back to try to see where the change began, I find it in this incident in the barracks outside Honolulu.

Why? I'm not sure I know. Perhaps it was my surrender of the child-prodigy status. Perhaps it was my feeling that I had grown up, I had proved myself, and I no longer had to give everyone a headache convincing them that I was, too, smart. (Of course, I backslide now and then, but not often.)

4

Oahu was a pleasant place. In fact, though I consciously resented being there as part of the Army, I couldn't help but enjoy it a little bit.

There was something unutterably free about always being able to wear shirtsleeves—about feeling no concern for rain. Every day it clouded up and rained now and then, but the rain never lasted for longer than a few minutes at a time and then the sun came out and dried you. 2

There were flowers everywhere and the people were delightful, though downtown Honolulu itself was unpleasantly commercialized.

2 This wasn't always so. On April 17 and April 20, there were steady all-day rains of the kind I was accustomed to.

We visited Waikiki beach, which did not live up to its Hollywood reputation. I was, in fact (used as I was to Coney Island), amazed at its small depth.

We took tours around Oahu and we visited the Dole pineapple plant on April 18. What I remember most vividly about the sights of Oahu, in fact, was a faucet in the lobby of the Dole plant. When turned, it delivered not water, but pineapple juice—and not just pineapple juice, but the best I've ever tasted before or since, thick and sweet. I had five cups.

We also periodically visited the USO in Honolulu, which I always enjoyed except for one unpleasant event. At one time, the song "God Bless America" was played, and everyone in the place stood up and sang along.

As it happens, however, I think the song is a disaster. The tune is one long cliche and the words are embarrassingly mawkish. So I didn't stand up and I didn't sing, and I was pretty conspicuous.